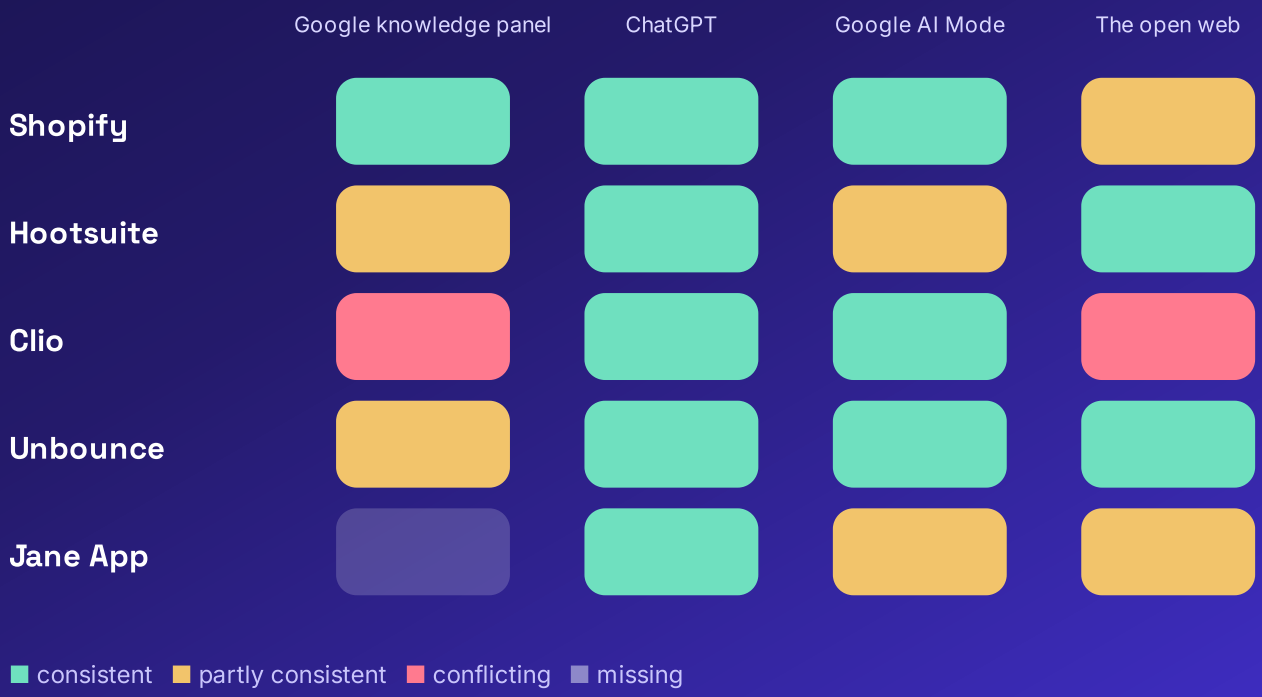
Who Are You, Really?

How consistently do Google and AI assistants describe five Canadian B2B SaaS brands?



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5 brands, 4 core facts, 4 kinds of source
Collected October 22, 2026

The short version

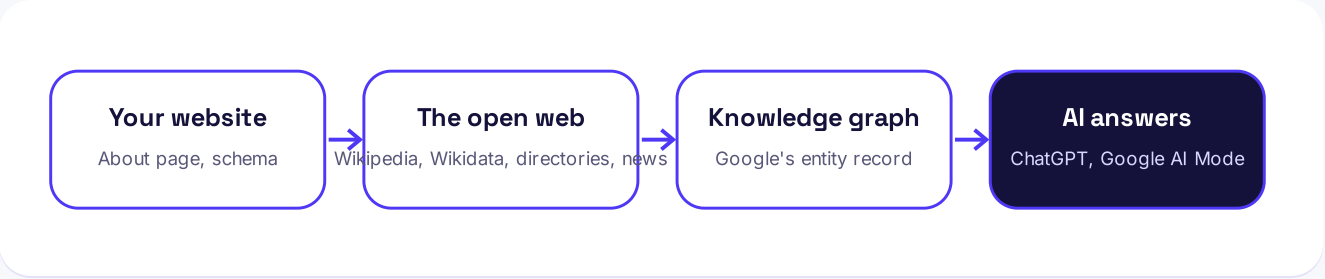
Before an AI assistant recommends a company, it has to know what the company is. I checked how Google and two AI assistants describe five Canadian B2B SaaS brands, from Shopify to Jane App, on four basic facts: when it was founded, by whom, where it's based and who runs it.

4 → 0	**The knowledge graph thins out fast.** Shopify's Google knowledge panel showed all four facts; Hootsuite three; Unbounce two; Clio one. Jane App had no panel at all.
3 of 5	**“Founded” is the shakiest fact.** Three brands have two or more founding years in circulation, often traceable to the company's own storytelling.
2	**Google disagrees with itself.** For Clio and Unbounce, Google's knowledge panel and Google AI Mode gave different answers.
April 2026	**AI answers were more current.** Both assistants named Hootsuite's interim CEO, who took over in April. The knowledge panel showed only the CFO.
1 word	**Wording decides the entity.** Searching "Shopify company" or "Hootsuite company" showed a local office listing, not the company's knowledge panel.

What it means for B2B brands: AI visibility starts with being clearly, consistently known. One canonical version of your core facts, published and linked everywhere, is the foundation everything else stands on.

Why brand facts matter

Search engines and AI assistants don't just read pages. They build a record of each company, an entity, and answer from it.



How a company's facts travel from its own site to an AI answer.

An entity is a set of facts

To Google, a company is a set of facts it trusts: a name, a founding date, founders, a location, leaders, a website and links to profiles elsewhere. Those facts power the knowledge panel beside search results, and they're part of what AI assistants retrieve when someone asks about the company.

Inconsistency costs confidence

When sources disagree, systems have to pick a version or hedge. That's where wrong founding years, missing founders and out-of-date leaders come from. For a B2B buyer checking a vendor, that's the first impression.

What this study checks

Is the record complete?
How much of each brand's core record Google's knowledge panel shows.

Do sources agree?
Whether the panel, two AI assistants and the open web tell the same story.

Is it current?
Whether recent changes, like a new CEO, reach the answers.

How the study worked

Five Vancouver-area and Canadian B2B software companies of very different sizes, four facts each, compared across four kinds of source.

1

Pick the brands

Shopify, Hootsuite, Clio, Unbounce and Jane App: from a public giant to a private scale-up.

2

Check Google

The knowledge panel for each brand's name and for "[brand] company".

3

Ask the assistants

ChatGPT (temporary chat) and Google AI Mode: when founded, by whom, where, and who is CEO.

4

Check the web

Wikipedia, directories, interviews and news, to find where each version comes from.

Founded
The year the company began

Founders
Who started it

Headquarters
Where it's based

CEO
Who runs it today

Collected on October 22, 2026, from Vancouver. The assistants were asked one question per brand: "What is [brand]? When was it founded, who founded it, where is it headquartered, and who is its CEO?" Where sources disagreed, I traced the versions to company statements, interviews and news reports. Results are a snapshot: panels and AI answers change over time.

The consistency matrix

Every brand, every fact, every source. Green means the sources agree; amber, they partly agree; red, they conflict; grey, Google's knowledge panel is silent and only the AI assistants answer.

	Founded	Founders	Headquarters	CEO
Shopify	2006 everywhere official. ChatGPT and AI Mode add: origins in 2004. Copied web pages say 2004.	Three in the panel and both AIs. Older copies of Wikipedia list two.	Ottawa, in the panel and both AIs.	Tobias Lütke, in the panel and both AIs.
Hootsuite	2008 everywhere; both AIs give November 28, 2008.	Three in the panel and ChatGPT. AI Mode names Ryan Holmes and 'partners'.	Vancouver everywhere.	Panel shows only the CFO. Both AIs: Ryan Holmes, interim CEO since April 2026.
Clio	Panel: 2007. ChatGPT: 2008. AI Mode: October 2008. Clio's own bios say both.	Not in the panel. Both AIs: Jack Newton and Rian Gauvreau.	Not in the panel. Both AIs: Burnaby. One data site: Washington, US.	Not in the panel. Both AIs: Jack Newton.
Unbounce	2009 in the panel and both AIs.	Panel lists five founders, leaving out Rick Perreault. Both AIs list six.	Not in the panel. Both AIs: Vancouver.	Not in the panel. Both AIs: Steve Oriola, since 2024.
Jane App	No panel. ChatGPT: 2012, launched 2014. AI Mode: 2011, launched March 2014.	No panel. Both AIs: Alison Taylor and Trevor Johnston.	No panel. Both AIs: North Vancouver.	No panel. Both AIs: the two co-founders as co-CEOs.

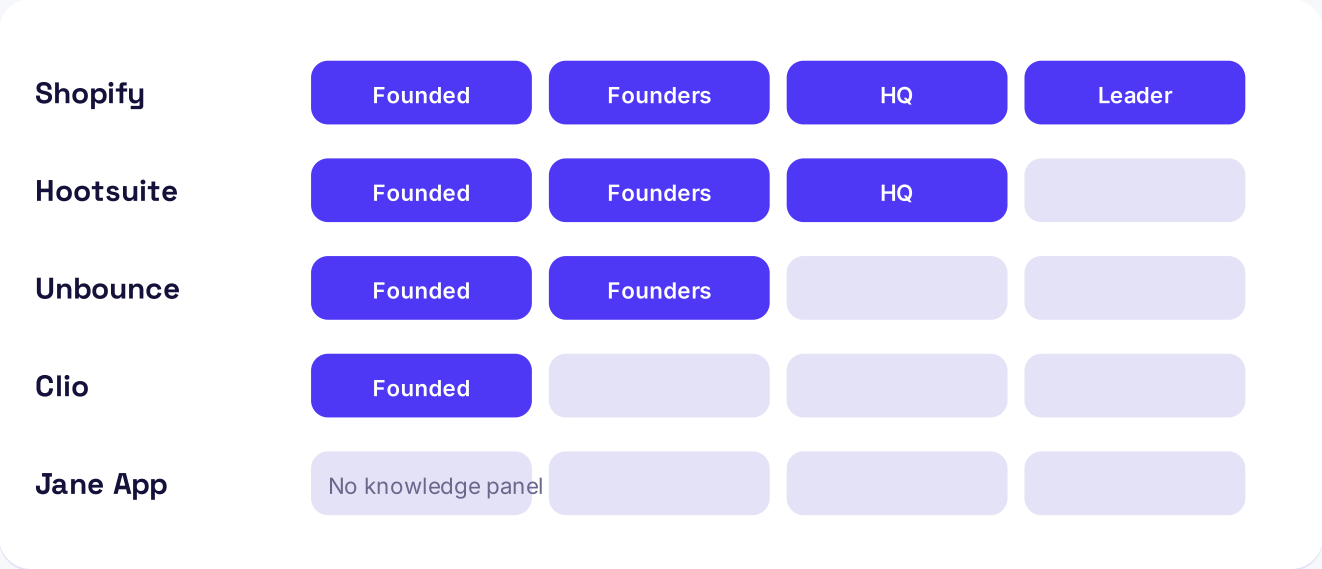
Consistent · Partly consistent · Conflicting · Missing from the knowledge panel

Read across a row, and size matters less than you'd think. Shopify is almost all green. Clio, a company valued at over a billion dollars, has as many gaps as Jane App, a fraction of its size.

Finding 1

The knowledge graph thins out fast

How much of each brand's core record appeared in Google's knowledge panel.



Facts shown in the knowledge panel for each brand's name (Hootsuite's "leader" was its CFO, not its CEO).

Bigger helps, but it isn't the whole story

Shopify, a public company with a detailed Wikipedia page, has a complete record. But Clio, a legal-tech unicorn, showed only a founding year. Size and fame don't automatically fill the graph; clear, consistent, well-linked facts do.

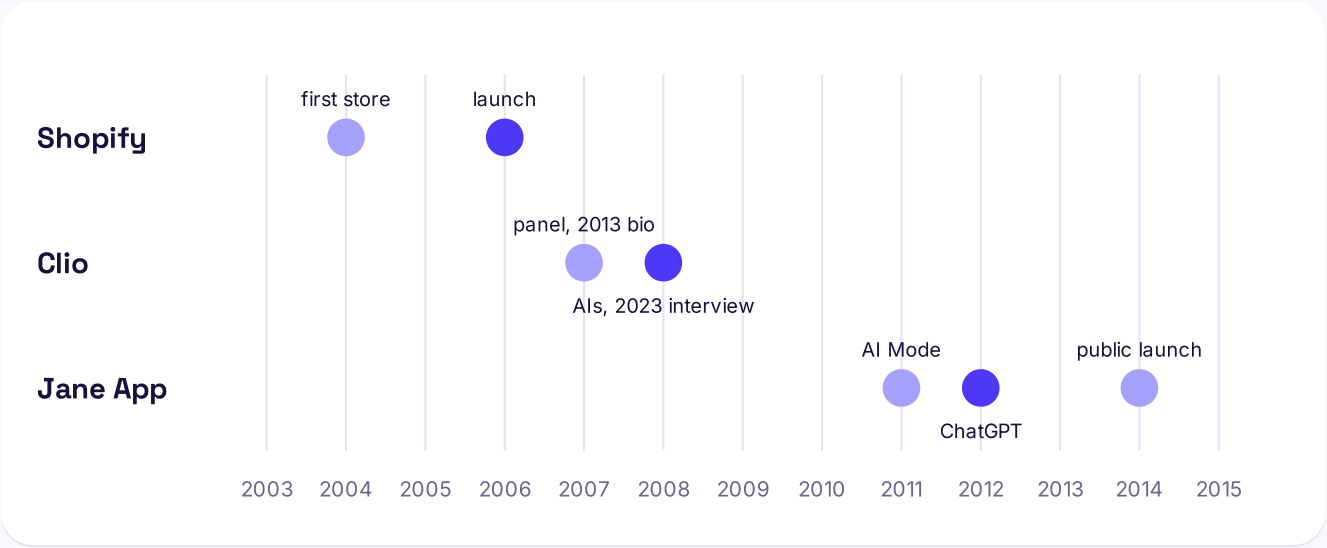
AI fills the gap, without a safety net

Where the panel was empty, the AI assistants still answered confidently from websites, interviews and news. That works when the web agrees. When it doesn't, there's no authoritative record to correct the answer.

Finding 2

“Founded” is the shakiest fact

Three of five brands have two or more founding years in circulation. The cause usually isn't a careless website. It's the company's own story.



Founding years found for each brand across the knowledge panel, AI answers and the web.

Shopify

Snowdevil, the founders' first store, opened in 2004; Shopify launched in 2006. Copied web pages turned that into "founded in 2004".

Clio

A 2013 event bio of its CEO said 2007; a 2023 interview marking 15 years said 2008. Google's panel took one, the AIs the other.

Jane App

An internal tool in 2011, a company around 2012, a public launch in 2014. Each AI picked a different milestone.

The fix is a definition, not a guess. Say which date "founded" means, and say it the same way everywhere: "Founded in 2008, incorporated in 2007."

Findings 3 and 4

Google disagrees with itself, and AI is more current

Two surprises: the same company can get different facts from different Google features, and the AI answers were often more up to date than the knowledge panel.

Clio, founding year

Knowledge panel 2007

Google AI Mode October 2008

Same company, same search engine, two different answers.

Unbounce, founders

Knowledge panel five founders

Google AI Mode six, including Rick Perreault

The panel's list leaves out a co-founder who was also the original CEO.

Who is Hootsuite's CEO?

Google knowledge panel

Shows the company's CFO, and no CEO.

ChatGPT and Google AI Mode

Both name Ryan Holmes, the founder who returned as interim CEO in April 2026, which matches news reports at the time.

Different features, different sources

The knowledge panel draws on Google's stored entity record. AI Mode builds its answer from pages it retrieves at the moment. When the record and the web disagree, the two features drift apart.

News travels faster than the graph

Leadership changes are covered in news and posted on LinkedIn within hours. The stored record lags behind, so for anything recent, a brand's newsroom and profiles matter most.

Findings 5 and 6

One word swaps the entity, and copies spread errors

”Shopify company”

Showed a local listing for Shopify's Vancouver office: an address and Google reviews. Searching "Shopify Inc" showed the full company panel.

”Hootsuite company”

Showed the Vancouver office listing, with its reviews on display, instead of the company record. "Hootsuite Inc" showed the company panel.

For brands with physical offices, the local listing is a separate entity, and for some searches near an office it can take the place of the company itself. What people see first depends on a single word.

How copied pages multiply errors

Brand	What a third-party page claimed	What the record shows
Shopify	Founded in 2004 by University of Waterloo students; public in 2012	Launched 2006; public in 2015
Shopify	Two founders (older copies of Wikipedia)	Three founders
Clio	Based in Washington, United States, listed beside a different "Clio" founded in 2006	Burnaby, British Columbia
Shopify	7,600, 8,100 or "5,001 to 10,000" employees, depending on the site	Changes yearly; one dated figure is needed

These pages are what AI systems can retrieve. An error repeated on enough of them starts to look like a fact.

What B2B brands can do

Six moves to make sure Google and AI assistants know exactly who you are.

Write down your canonical facts

One short facts section on your About page: founding date and what it means, founders, headquarters, leaders, size with a date.

The evidence: Three of five brands had competing founding years.

Mark it up with Organization schema

foundingDate, founder, address, and sameAs links to Wikipedia, Wikidata, LinkedIn and Crunchbase.

The evidence: Google's panel and AI Mode disagreed on Clio and Unbounce.

Claim and correct your knowledge panel

Verify the brand with Google and suggest edits where facts are missing or wrong.

The evidence: Clio's panel showed one fact; Jane App had no panel.

Keep Wikidata and Wikipedia accurate

Add referenced facts to Wikidata, the open record many systems read; follow Wikipedia's conflict-of-interest rules.

The evidence: Shopify, with the most complete Wikipedia page, had the most complete record.

Announce changes where AI looks

Leadership news on your newsroom and LinkedIn the same day, then update every profile.

The evidence: Both AIs knew Hootsuite's new CEO; the panel didn't.

Separate your company from your offices

Name office listings clearly and link them to the company, so brand searches find the right entity.

The evidence: '[Brand] company' showed office listings for Shopify and Hootsuite.

Limits, and what's next

Read this as a snapshot

- Five brands, four facts, one day. A larger set would show how common each pattern is.
- Knowledge panels and AI answers change; the same searches could look different next month.
- Results came from Vancouver, which likely explains the local office listings.
- Where sources disagreed, I reported the versions and where they came from, rather than ruling on the truth, except where news reports settled it.

The series so far

Study 1, The AI Shelf: which sustainable apparel brands AI recommends. **Study 2, this report:** brand consistency and the knowledge graph. Next: **E-E-A-T across small, mid-size and large e-commerce brands**, then **information gain and AI retrieval** in buying guides.

Independent research

This is an independent analysis based on publicly available search results, AI answers and web pages. I have not worked with, or been endorsed by, any company mentioned. Facts are reported as each source presented them.

SEO Girl

Where AI meets search, I make brands visible.

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